

Zambia's Health and Economic Development (1990 – 2023)

Summary Report

This summary provides an overview of the country's health and economic trajectory from 1990 to 2023. The focus is on life expectancy at birth, Gross Domestic Product (GDP) per capita, and health expenditure.

The dataset with the information I used for the analysis were,

From the World Bank data,

- Life expectancy at birth, total (years)

From the UN data,

- Nutrition and health - Health expenditure
- National Accounts - GDP and GDP per Capita

From this dataset, I only got to analyse the data for Zambia from the documents, for the period 1990 to 2023.

Life Expectancy at birth

Life expectancy at birth indicates the number of years a newborn infant would live if prevailing patterns of mortality at the time of its birth were to stay the same throughout its life. Life expectancy at birth of Zambia has had a steady increase in the three decades since 1990 and this indicates an improvement in healthcare, living standards.

GDP per Capita

GDP per Capita is a key economic metric representing a country's total economic output (GDP) divided by its total population, essentially measuring average income per person. It is used to compare prosperity and living standards across nations. GDP per capita from 1995 to 2023 has increased in Zambia, indicating an improvement in living standards, thereby improving the life expectancy of the population.

Health Expenditure

Health expenditure as a percentage of GDP measures the share of a country's total economic wealth channelled into healthcare goods and services annually. Health Expenditure illustrates government commitment and investment appetite to healthcare financing. This is seen with the increase in the percentage of GDP in the years.

Conclusion

There is a relationship between the economic growth and health investment, and longevity of a country. Rising GDP provides resources for expanded health improvements, thereby contributing to the increase in life expectancy. That is, as GDP per capita increases, life expectancy at birth increases, and as health expenditure increases, life expectancy at birth increases. Looking forward, maintain the synergy between prosperity and health financing will be essential to consolidating gains and addressing emerging challenges.

Limitations

The GDP Per capita and the Health Expenditure have intermittent data entered as it is not continuous, it is inconsistent. It is the years that are 5 years apart that has the data which makes it difficult to align the information with the life expectancy which has continuous data which is consistent with the years from 1990 to 2023.